

Determinatives as nouns in English

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Abstract

I argue that English determinatives belong within Noun alongside common nouns, proper nouns, and pronouns. Their combined semantic, syntactic, and morphological profile supports the grouping; quantificational common nouns provide particularly close connections. Adverbial premodification and grade distinguish determinatives within it. I examine restricted articles, reconsider independent *what*'s pronoun classification, and address determinatives' degree-modifier uses. The proposed hierarchy makes nominal projection inherited, unifying bare, partitive, and externally determined uses under ordinary Head structure. A matched grammatical fragment compares separate-D alternatives and identifies the costs of restricting modifier generalizations to subcategories.

Keywords: determinatives, nouns, lexical categories, noun phrases, English

I THE QUESTION

What is the categorial relationship among words such as *some*, *me*, *apple*, and *Brett*? I argue that all four are nouns: determinatives form a coordinate subcategory alongside common nouns, proper nouns, and pronouns. I write the superordinate category as Noun and call the fourfold proposal the DETERMINATIVE-NOUN or D-NOUN ANALYSIS.

I adopt the general framework of *The Cambridge grammar of the English language* (CGEL; Huddleston and Pullum 2002). Unlike CGEL, though, I include determinatives within Noun. The claims concern synchronic English lexical categories.¹

I use DETERMINATIVE for the category containing articles, demonstratives, and quantifiers such as *the*, *this*, *some*, *every*, and *many*.² I reserve DETERMINER for the syntactic function within the noun phrase characteristically performed by phrases headed by these words. This distinction separates what kind of word *some* is from what syntactic relationships its phrase participates in.

CGEL already includes pronouns within Noun on the basis of their phrases' functions, despite differences from common and proper nouns in inflection and dependents (Huddleston & Pullum,

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¹I treat these categories as language-specific: a classification supported by another language's grammar doesn't determine the English classification.

²For a fuller inventory, see the online "[List of determinatives in English](#)" accompanying Huddleston et al. (2022).

2002, pp. 327–328). The inclusion of auxiliaries within Verb supplies a further precedent for preserving distinctive properties within a broader lexical category (Pullum & Wilson, 1977). The question is whether determinatives’ combined semantic, syntactic, and morphological profile warrants the corresponding extension of Noun.

In the D-noun analysis, determinatives inherit the nominal projection rules of Noun. Under these rules, a determinative heads a NOMINAL (Nom), which heads an NP, just as common nouns, proper nouns, and pronouns do. Nom contains the head and its internal dependents, excluding an external determiner. Lexical restrictions govern which uses are available.

Figure 1 compares *CGEL* with the D-noun analysis for *take some apples* and *take some*. Both keep *some* in one lexical category. In *CGEL*, independent *some* jointly fills determiner and head functions, a FUSION OF FUNCTIONS (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 410–412).³ In the D-noun analysis, *some* heads its own NP through a Nom in both uses; that NP functions as determiner before *apples* and as object in *take some*.

Here DP abbreviates DETERMINATIVE PHRASE, as in *CGEL*, not to be confused with the DP of the DP hypothesis, where D heads the whole expression *some apples* (Abney, 1987; §2.1). The D-noun analysis keeps *apples* as that expression’s ultimate head.

The same ordinary Head structure extends to bare *few*, partitive *few of them*, and externally determined *the lucky few*. *CGEL* divides these between Det–Head and Mod–Head fusion. Their unification is one structural consequence of the proposal. Another is that replacing DP with NP consolidates the phrase types functioning as determiner: determinatives join genitives and other nominal determiners.

The argument proceeds from classification to its consequences. Section 2.2 places the proposal among earlier accounts; §3 compares the four profiles, and §4 examines the nominal constructions. Sections 5 and 6 address subcategory rank and difficult members. The matched fragment in §7.2 then compares the resulting grammar with separate-D alternatives, holding judgments and lexical restrictions fixed.

2 CLASSIFICATION, HEADEDNESS, AND FUNCTION

2.1 CATEGORY, FUNCTION, AND PHRASE STRUCTURE

Lexical categories and syntactic functions cut across one another. An NP can function as determiner, as in *Kim’s book*, and a determinative-headed phrase can function as modifier, as in *the many people* (Payne et al., 2010; Pullum & Miller, 2022).

The question of lexical classification is distinct from the headedness question associated with the DP hypothesis of Abney (1987). Under that hypothesis, D heads expressions such as *some apples*. I retain noun-headed NPs and reject the DP analysis for English, following the arguments of Pullum and Miller (2022) and Bruening (2020).

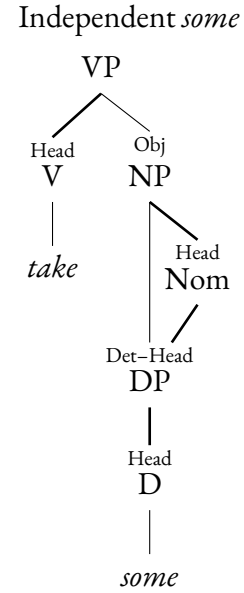
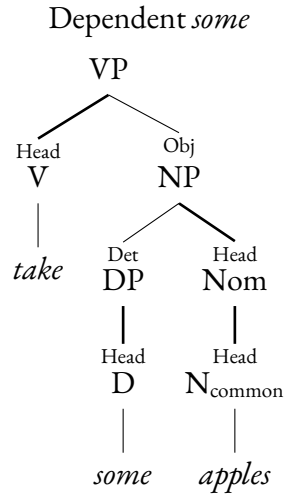
Category membership doesn’t remove lexical restrictions. *Every apple* is grammatical, but **I’ll take every* isn’t an ordinary way to accept apples. The fragment retains that restriction (§7.2).

2.2 TAXONOMIC AND STRUCTURAL ALTERNATIVES

Keeping a word in one category across dependent and independent uses leaves its taxonomic position open. As J. Lyons (1968, pp. 232–235) observes, distribution can be compared at different levels of

³As a syntactic representation, fusion of functions appears to have seen little adoption outside work based on *CGEL*.

CGEL



D-noun analysis

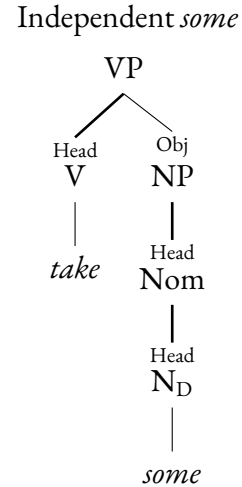
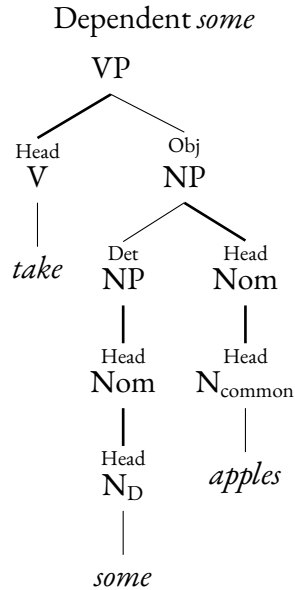


Figure 1: *Take some apples* (left) and *take some* (right) under CGEL (top) and the D-noun analysis (bottom). In the upper-right tree, DP fills Det of NP and Head of Nom. In the lower pair, *some* heads an NP through the same nominal projection; that NP functions as Det on the left and Obj on the right. Function labels appear above category labels. Det marks determiner, Obj object, and Det-Head fusion; the two links show the combined functions. N, D, and V mark noun, determinative, and verb; NP, DP, and VP mark their phrases. Subscripts identify noun subcategories.

categorization: two expressions may belong together at one level and differ at a more specific level. Table 1 distinguishes the selected authors' proposals, their analytical levels, and several logical alternatives. The D-noun analysis differs from *CGEL* by including determinative within Noun, and from Hudson by placing it alongside pronoun.

Table 1: Selected accounts and logical alternatives. The earlier proposals differ in scope and representational level; they don't all specify a surface taxonomy. The prose gives sources and inventory qualifications.

Account	Proposed relationship	Level or status
Palmer	Determinative adjectives grouped with pronouns.	Lexical grouping; inclusive Noun unspecified
Postal	Personal pronouns analysed as articles, with deeper noun features.	Intermediate and underlying representations
Sommerstein	Definite article and personal pronouns given NP structure.	Underlying representation
Lyons	Articles, demonstratives, and personal pronouns linked by definiteness and deixis.	Semantic relationship
<i>CGEL</i>	Pronoun within Noun; determinative separate.	Lexical taxonomy
Hudson	Determiners within pronoun, which is within noun.	Lexical taxonomy
Spinillo	Determinatives redistributed; <i>the</i> , <i>a</i> , and <i>every</i> retained as articles.	Lexical reclassification
D-noun analysis	Common noun, proper noun, pronoun, and determinative coordinate within Noun.	Proposed taxonomy
Logical alternative	Noun, pronoun, and determinative separate.	For comparison
Logical alternative	Determinative within Noun; pronoun separate.	For comparison
Logical alternative	Pronoun within determinative, which is within Noun.	For comparison
Logical alternative	Pronoun within proper noun; determinative within common noun.	For comparison

Palmer (1924, p. 24) proposed placing “determinative adjectives” with pronouns. He contrasted them with qualifying adjectives, which permit predicative use, comparison, and adverbial modification. Most determinatives, he observed, can “be used indifferently as pronouns or as modifiers of nouns”. J. Lyons (1968, p. 279) adds a semantic connection: articles, demonstratives, and personal pronouns share definiteness and deictic contrasts.

Postal (1966) develops the article–pronoun connection through English reflexives and combinations such as *we men*. His morphological evidence for the noun *self* includes *selfish*, *selfless*, and the plural alternation *self/selves*; he analyses the preceding pronominal material as an article. The classification depends on representational level: article segments occur at intermediate stages, their deepest counterparts are features of nouns, and surface pronouns can receive derivative Noun status.

Sommerstein (1972, pp. 197–203) argues in the opposite direction, giving the definite article and personal pronouns underlying NP structure. His English comparison includes the count restriction on anaphoric *one*, whereas *it* can refer to a quantity of a substance.⁴ He also observes that noun status for *self* doesn't decide whether the preceding element is an article or a genitive pronoun.

These predecessors challenge a fundamental article–pronoun separation, but leave the full determinative inventory unclassified. Its contrasts in grade, modification, complementation, and restricted independent use extend the comparison beyond their proposals.

Hudson makes taxonomic inclusion explicit. His noun category contains common noun, proper noun, and pronoun (Hudson, 2010, pp. 253–254); a determiner is a pronoun whose VALENCY permits the relevant common-noun dependent (Hudson, 2004, pp. 9–10). The word's category remains constant across independent and dependent uses, which differ in their permitted dependents.

Hudson's criteria centre on licensing a singular count common noun and on mutual exclusion in that use. He sets aside *all*, cardinal numerals, and quantifiers restricted to plural or non-count nouns (Hudson, 2004, pp. 9–10). Their place in his taxonomy remains unsettled by those criteria. Extending the pronoun analysis to CGEL's fuller inventory requires comparing its modifier selection, grade, and quantitative meanings with the existing pronouns' properties.

Hudson also distinguishes dependency from external headedness. He argues that determiner and common noun depend on each other, although only one connects the phrase to its surroundings (Hudson, 2004, pp. 7–8). His temporal adjunct evidence supports common-noun headedness: *I saw him that day* is possible, whereas **I saw him that point in time* isn't, despite the similar temporal meanings (Hudson, 2004, pp. 10–12). The lexical noun matters, as well as the construction's determiner restrictions.

The reciprocal selection facts are substantial: a singular count noun normally requires determination, while *every* requires an overt nominal and *some* doesn't. They establish conditions in both directions. In the present phrase-structure analysis, the noun can remain Head while both constituents impose such conditions (§7.2). Including determinatives within Noun neither explains away the selection facts nor requires mutual headedness; it concerns the selecting words' superordinate category.

Spinillo (2004, pp. 153–158) instead retains *the*, *a*, and *every* as an expanded article category and redistributes other determinatives. Her grounds include dependence on a following nominal, lack of predicative and partitive uses, and limited descriptive content. She also recognizes differences within the trio. Section 6 assesses this cluster against the connections each member retains with the wider inventory.

Spinillo (2004, pp. 140–144) draws an analogy with verbs and prepositions whose complements can be omitted. For demonstratives and quantifiers such as *some* and *all*, occurrence before a nominal (*some teachers*) alternates with occurrence without one (*some left*). The analogy supports category

⁴Payne et al. (2013, pp. 797–798) analyse anaphoric *one* as a common count noun, distinct from determinative *one* and personal pronoun *one*.

continuity, but leaves the category to be established: *CGEL*, Hudson, and the D-noun analysis can all preserve it.

3 THE D-NOUN ANALYSIS

3.1 THE BASIS FOR A BROADER NOUN CATEGORY

Table 2 compares the four proposed subcategories. The issue is the combined profile: how broadly a property occurs within each group, where it recurs across constructions, and how specifically it connects determinatives with nouns or adjectives.

Meaning and reference vary within Noun. *Apple* describes a class; *Kim*, in its primary naming use, identifies through a name; *she* depends on context. Determinatives range from deictic *this* to quantitative *many* and universal *every* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 358–360, 370–405, 425–428, 515–521). Deixis connects demonstratives with pronouns, while quantity connects determinatives with common nouns such as *number* and *majority*.

These meanings aren't exclusive to nouns. Adjectives such as *singular* and *plural* also concern number; *proximate* and *distal* describe spatial relations relevant to demonstrative contrasts, though spatial meaning needn't itself be deictic. Nor does Noun imply close semantic similarity throughout: *every* quantifies over a nominal restriction, while *Kim* identifies an individual. Semantic affinities contribute to the comparison without settling its boundaries.

Pro-form gender (Reynolds, 2025) connects these ways of referring. Descriptions such as *the woman* and names such as *Kim* identify referents whose construal bears on pro-form choice. Pronouns and determinatives express contrasts between personal *she/somebody* and non-personal *it/something*. Relative *who/which* supplies another contrast; independent *what* raises a classification question taken up in §6.2.

External syntax supplies a broad overlap in the functions available to the phrases. *CGEL* makes this the stated ground for including pronouns within Noun (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 327). A range of determinatives likewise occurs in subject, object, and complement-of-preposition positions without another overt nominal head. The examples in §4.1 compare these uses across all four proposed subcategories.

Modifier and adjunct functions also cut across the groups. Compare the modifiers in *dog houses*, *Canada Day*, *the manager herself*, and *the few people*. Emphatic *herself* also functions as a clause adjunct in *The manager detected the error herself* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 1496–1497). Temporal NPs such as *that day* and *Sunday* supply adjuncts, as does degree *enough* in *I hadn't prepared enough* (§6.3). These are shared functions with construction-specific distributions.

Interrogative, relative, and exclamative properties must be distinguished from those functions. An interrogative object may be headed by a pronoun (*who*) or a common noun (*which book*); the latter obtains its interrogative property from a dependent. Similarly, *What a nice day!* requires exclamative *what*; substituting an ordinary NP doesn't preserve the construction. *CGEL* classifies this *what* as an adjective, distinct from interrogative and relative *what* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, 433–437, Ch. 10, §7).

Overlap with adjectives likewise needs phrase levels kept distinct. Both *the people* and *the rich* are NPs in *CGEL*, though only the former has a noun as lexical head. In *a soccer/round ball*, Nom and AdjP share modifier function; in *Jones became president/ill*, NP and AdjP share predicative complement function. External functions alone therefore don't establish nounhood.

Table 2: Representative profiles, with ranges rather than universal properties. Argument and Det functions concern whole phrases; modifier examples involve Nom or NP as appropriate. Construction type is distinct from function. The determinative inventory includes the reassignment of independent *what* and relative *which* argued for in §6.2.

Dimension	Common noun	Proper noun	Pronoun	Determinative
Inventory	Open	Open to new names	Closed	Closed
Argument / Det functions	NP arguments; genitive Det	NP arguments; genitive Det	NP arguments; genitive Det	NP arguments; plain and genitive Det <i>the few people</i> ;
Modifier / adjunct functions	<i>dog houses; that day</i>	<i>Canada Day; Sunday</i>	Emphatic reflexives in both functions	degree adjuncts
Interrogative / relative constructions	Through another constituent, e.g. <i>which book</i>	Through another constituent	<i>who, whose</i>	<i>which, what</i> , and <i>-ever</i> forms
Meaning	Descriptive properties and relations	Naming in primary uses	Person, deixis, anaphora, and interrogation	Quantification, definiteness, deixis, and interrogation
Pro-form gender	Descriptions shape referent construal	Names identify referents construed by gender	Gender-sensitive forms	Gender-sensitive forms and constructions
Inflection	Number and genitive	Genitive; restricted number	Case, including genitive; reflexive forms	Number; grade; genitive; <i>no/none</i>
Accepts determination	Broad contrasts; singular count arguments normally require it	Restricted in primary naming uses	Normally excluded	Lexically restricted: <i>the few, these three</i>
Internal modification	Productive AdjP and nominal premodifiers; relative postmodifiers	Restricted AdjP premodifiers and embellishments	Restricted AdjP premodifiers and relative postmodifiers	AdvP and D premodifiers; nominal postmodifiers; <i>the lucky few</i>
Complementation	Selected PPs and clauses	Not characteristic of primary naming uses	Normally absent	Partitive <i>of</i> -PPs; comparative <i>than</i> -phrases

Complementation sharpens the comparison. Common nouns and determinatives take partitive complements: *a lot/some of the wine*. Comparative complements such as *more than ten* instead connect determinatives with adjectives (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 349–350, 392–394, 411–412, 432–433). Common nouns permit PP and clausal complements more generally; pronouns and primary naming uses of proper nouns have much more restricted dependents (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 429–430, 439–443, 517–521). Determinatives combine nominal complement and postmodifier constructions with their own selectional restrictions.

Quantificational common nouns make the connection more specific than shared quantity meanings. In *a lot of the delegates* and *many of the delegates*, both heads quantify over a partitive domain. Yet *lot* permits *a lot of delegates*, whereas **many of delegates* is excluded. *CGEL* also classifies *plenty* as a common noun whose quantificational use resists determination and modification (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 349–350). Established common nouns thus approach the determinative profile as determinatives approach theirs.

Ordinary count nouns alone are consequently an inadequate comparison class. Quantificational common nouns already combine selected *of*-complements with restricted dependents. Determinatives extend this pattern within Noun, adding the broad specialization in plain-case Det and the premodifier contrast examined in §3.3.

Inflection supplies overlapping contrasts too. Common nouns inflect for number and genitive; proper nouns permit number distinctions in restricted uses. Pronouns distinguish case, including genitive, and reflexive forms. Within determinative, *this/these* shows number, *few/fewer/fewest* grade, and *something's* genitive (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 373, 423–424, 426, 479–480, 521). Number and case connect parts of the inventory with nouns; grade connects another part with adjectives.

CGEL treats singular and plural *you* as distinct lexemes whose difference is overt only in the reflexive forms *yourself* and *yourselves* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 486). Here number distinguishes lexemes rather than inflectional forms of one lexeme.

The adjectival affinities likewise vary across the inventory. Grade connects *few*, *many*, *much*, and *little* with adjectives, and their comparative forms take *than*-complements. Predicative use extends to *several*, and AdvP premodification extends much further. Even the gradable forms have distinct syntax: *so many mistakes* contrasts with **so numerous mistakes* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 392–396, 539–540).

The case for inclusion rests on this distribution of connections. Determinatives share argument and determiner functions with all three noun subcategories, referential contrasts with pronouns, and number, genitive marking, and partitive constructions with established parts of Noun. Adverbial premodification is a broad counterweight; grade and comparative complementation connect a smaller set with adjectives. I give greater weight to the recurring nominal profile, while preserving those countervailing properties in the determinative subcategory.

The D-noun analysis captures shared properties through INHERITANCE: a property stated for a superordinate category is available to its subcategories, subject to stated restrictions. Determinatives therefore inherit nominal projection from Noun. Subcategory rules constrain combinatorics, and lexical entries distinguish such forms as independent *some* and dependent-only *every*.

3.2 NOUN PHRASES IN DETERMINER AND ARGUMENT FUNCTIONS

Determinatives' characteristic determiner use could support a separate primary category. But Det is itself specific to NP structure, where it marks definiteness and often contributes quantification (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 354–359). These tasks connect it with the reference and number properties compared above. The question is whether this specialization warrants a primary boundary within nominal grammar.

Determiner function already cuts across the existing noun subcategories. Compare *my preferences*, *Kim's preferences*, and *people's preferences*. The determiner is an NP ultimately headed by a pronoun, a proper noun, and a common noun respectively (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 354–355, 470–471).⁵ Figure 2 illustrates the proper-noun case.

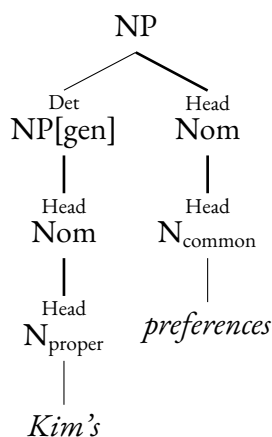


Figure 2: The genitive NP *Kim's* functions as determiner within *Kim's preferences*, ultimately headed by *preferences*. The representation abstracts from the internal realization of genitive marking.

The compound determinative *someone*, following the classification of Payne et al. (2007, §1.3), joins this pattern in *someone's preferences*: its genitive NP fills the same determiner function. The nominal base in *someone* may contribute to that permission, and most determinatives resist case marking.

The NP headed by *some* likewise functions as Det in *take some apples* and as object in *take some* (Figure 1). Its subcategory and nominal projection remain constant across these uses.

NP becomes the shared phrase type for the principal realizations of determiner function. Plain determinatives, including modified forms such as *almost ten*, join genitives such as *Kim's* and *my*. Minor determiners include further NPs: *what size* in *what size shoes*, *that size* in *that size shoes*, and *Sunday* in *Sunday morning* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 356).

These existing NP determiners give the extension a functional basis. In *Kim's preferences*, the embedded NP supplies an identifying anchor through its own referent; *Sunday* and *what size* specify a day or a dimension. Determinatives' deictic and quantitative specifications fit this nominal pattern. I take that fit to support treating their specialization in Det as a distinction within Noun.

⁵CGEL assigns these genitives the combined function Subject–Det (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 472–473). I treat them as Det here, without the additional subject function.

PPs remain a restricted alternative, as in *up to twenty minutes* and *between fifty and sixty tanks* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 356). Number, countability, and other selectional conditions distinguish the determining expressions.

3.3 MODIFIER SELECTION AND TAXONOMIC LEVEL

Shared nominal projection doesn't make modifier permissions uniform. In *almost every experienced teacher* (Figure 3), the AdvP *almost* modifies the determinative noun *every*; the AdjP *experienced* modifies the common noun *teacher*, which ultimately heads the outer NP.

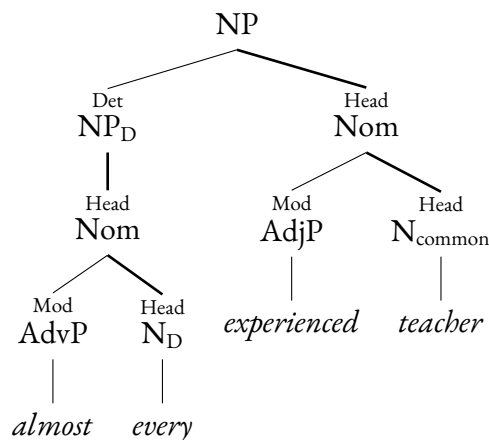


Figure 3: Two modifier relations in *almost every experienced teacher*: *almost* modifies *every*, and *experienced* modifies *teacher*. The outer NP has *teacher* as its ultimate head. Internal structure within the one-word modifier phrases is suppressed.

Payne et al. (2010, pp. 40–42) defend keeping *few*, *any*, and related forms in one lexical category across dependent and independent uses. In *hardly any money* and independent *hardly any*, *hardly* remains an adverb and *any* retains its category. The D-noun analysis preserves that continuity. It also preserves their contrast between adverbial premodification, as in *almost anybody*, and adjectival postmodification, as in *nothing absolute*.

The systematic use of AdvP premodifiers is the strongest internal-syntactic objection to the D-noun analysis. In the other three noun subcategories, internal premodifiers are normally adjectival or nominal. Adverbs occurring before a whole NP, as in *only you*, are peripheral modifiers of the NP, rather than internal modifiers of its head (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 430–431).

Determinatives also permit determinative premodifiers, as in *this much* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 393). Under the proposed analysis, this is a noun modifying another noun. Its licensing remains specific: the availability of one determinative modifier doesn't license arbitrary nominal premodification.

Payne et al. (2010, pp. 42–47) establish that adverbs can postmodify common nouns, and they analyse *almost* as modifying the attributive noun *textbook* in *an almost textbook case* (Payne et al., 2010, p. 75, n. 3). Adverbial modification therefore isn't categorically excluded from Noun. But neither postmodification nor a restricted attributive use removes the systematic contrast between *hardly any* or *almost every* and ordinary common-noun premodification.

Postmodifier permissions vary within Noun too. Common nouns freely take integrated relative clauses; personal pronouns permit a restricted range, including *we who have read the report* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 430). Compound determinatives permit them too, as in *something that you need to know* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 423–424).

Including determinatives places the premodifier contrast within Noun. The determinative subcategory licenses *hardly any* and *almost every*; common nouns license *experienced teacher*. Neither **experienced every* nor **almost teacher* follows. This contrast weighs against the grouping; §7.3 examines its consequences for stating the rules.

3.4 WORD FORMATION AND CATEGORY BOUNDARIES

Derivation supplies a less uniform comparison than inflection. Noun-forming suffixes differ in the bases they select: *-ship* in *friendship* primarily selects nouns denoting persons, though *hardship* has an adjective base; the inhabitant suffix *-er* in *Londoner* attaches to a place name (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, Ch. 19, §§5.6.2(b), 5.7.2(k)). No noun-selecting suffix shared by pronouns and determinatives is established here.

Determinatives enter derivations whose output is a common noun. *CGEL* cites *nothingness* and *oneness* among formations with *-ness* on non-adjectival bases (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, Ch. 19, §5.7.2(i)). Further established nouns include *thisness*, *fewness*, and *muchness*.⁶

-ness is the default suffix for forming nouns from adjectives, but also attaches to other bases, as in *whyness* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, Ch. 19, §5.7.2(i)). It therefore doesn't settle the input category of *nothingness*. A conversion analysis would require independent evidence for an intermediate base.

The adverb *mostly* provides a different output.⁷ Adverbial *-ly* primarily attaches to adjectives, but *CGEL* also gives noun-based *partly* and *purposely* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 566). This gives *most* an adjectival affinity without an adjective-only diagnostic.

Pronouns enter gender-marking compounds such as *he-goat* and *she-ass* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, Ch. 19, §5.3); determinatives combine with nominal material in *someone* and *anything*. Their determinative premodifier permissions recur in the compounds (§4.5), while the nominal component contributes further properties.

Numeral morphology extends the comparison to ordinal and fractional formations, analysed respectively as adjectival and nominal by Reynolds (2026). Their formation also bears on the boundary between a numeral lexeme and a syntactic phrase.

Morphology supplies mixed evidence: number and genitive marking give the clearest inflectional connections with nouns, while grade gives an adjectival connection. Derivation links some determinatives with common nouns through suffixes whose typical bases are adjectival.

4 EVIDENCE FOR NOMINAL STRUCTURE

Independent uses, partitives, and modification show a recurring nominal pattern. The observations overlap: *Some left* illustrates both external distribution and syntactic completeness. Fusion and ordinary headedness offer different internal analyses of these constructions.

⁶See *Merriam-Webster.com Dictionary*, s.v. *thisness* and *fewness*, and *Dictionary.com*, s.v. *muchness* (accessed 10 September 2026). These attestations don't establish a uniformly productive modern rule.

⁷See *Dictionary.com*, s.v. *mostly* (accessed 10 September 2026).

4.1 BREADTH OF INDEPENDENT USE

Independent use is widespread within the determinative inventory. *CGEL* discusses such uses for demonstratives and quantifiers including *some*, *all*, *both*, *many*, *few*, *several*, *each*, *either*, *neither*, *much*, and *enough*, while recording lexical restrictions and the separate forms *no/none* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 371–372, 410–424). The generalization concerns the availability of independent constructions across a lexical category, not unrestricted acceptability in every sentence frame.⁸

In the constructed examples in (1), compare the bracketed NPs as subjects, objects, and complements of prepositions. Assume that a woman named Kim and a group of people are already under discussion. The competing analyses assign different internal structures to independent *some*.

- (1) a. [People] left. I see [people]. with [people]
 b. [Kim] left. I see [Kim]. with [Kim]
 c. [She] left. I see [her]. with [her]
 d. [Some] left. I see [some]. with [some]

Adjectival independent uses prevent a simple inference from these positions to nounhood. *The rich* and *the poor* can fill nominal argument positions. Comparative and superlative adjectives also head expressions without a human-class interpretation: *CGEL's the most important of her criticisms* is an NP containing a partitive *of*-phrase (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 332–333, 416–423).

Independent *some* can form a one-word NP, whereas an NP with *rich* as fused head normally requires a determiner on the human-class reading. That is a local contrast: argument NPs headed by singular count common nouns also need determination. Section 4.4 returns to the fuller adjectival comparison.

4.2 STRUCTURAL SATURATION AND INTERPRETATION

With a group of people under discussion, *Some left*, *Many came*, and *All agree* illustrate **STRUCTURAL SATURATION**: an argument expression can be syntactically complete without another overt head or determiner. Syntactic completeness differs from contextual interpretation. In *I'll take some*, the relevant substance or set may be supplied by discourse or the situation. That dependence doesn't establish a deleted common noun: ordinary pronouns also depend on context.

In the following attestation from the CGELBank treebank, *two different Honda models* supplies the domain for the independent object *both*:⁹

- (2) *Went there yesterday: we are trying to decide between two different Honda models, so we wanted to test-drive both back to back.*

Generalizing expressions such as *Many are called*, *few are chosen* and *Enough is enough* need no previously uttered common-noun phrase. They rule out a mandatory overt-antecedent requirement,

⁸Material before a determiner falls outside the independent-use comparison. *CGEL* treats *all/both* in *all/both the books* as predeterminer modifiers, *quite/rather* before *a good idea* as peripheral modifiers, and *such/exclamative what* before *a disaster* as adjectives (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 433–437). The fixed *many a* is a complex determinative restricted to Det function (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 394). The *half* in *half a cake* is a common noun used as a predeterminer modifier (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 434). These constructions don't add evidence for independent determinative heads.

⁹CGELBank (Reynolds et al., 2023), sentence [reviews-083459-0002](#).

but a silent-noun account could supply a generic restriction. Such examples don't decide whether the restriction belongs in semantics or syntax.

The comparison with ordinary pronouns and proper nouns is structural as well as interpretive. In *She left* and *Kim left*, *CGEL* permits an NP headed by a nominal with no determiner. Applying that structure to *Some left* preserves the same division between a complete NP and its context-dependent reference. The dependent use of *some* doesn't by itself require a Det function inside every independent occurrence.

In Payne et al. (2007), one constituent jointly realizes Head and a dependent function, subject to structural and adjacency conditions. Under *CGEL*'s analysis of independent *some*, its DP fills Det of NP and Head of Nom. The word remains determinative, while the independent expression is an NP. Ordinary headedness instead gives *some* nominal projection, with the same restrictions on independence and form selection.

CGEL also uses fusion with nouns. It assigns anaphoric *mine* to Det–Head, but predicative possessive *mine*, as in *it's mine*, to pure Head (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 410–411). Nounhood is thus compatible with fusion. Here ordinary determinative headedness follows from the inherited projection rules; the analysis of independent genitives, including *Kim's* and *mine*, falls outside the fragment in §7.2.

4.3 PARTITIVES LOCATE THE QUANTIFICATIONAL HEAD

In *some of the wine*, *some* specifies a quantity drawn from an identifiable amount of wine. The NP *the wine* denotes the partitive DOMAIN: the whole from which that quantity is drawn. This NP is complement of *of*. A pronoun-headed NP or independent genitive NP can express the domain too: *many of them*, referring to previously mentioned people, or *some of Kim's*, referring to Kim's apples.

Compare where the common noun occurs in *some apples* and *some of the wine*. In the partitive, *wine* is embedded inside the *of*-phrase, so it can't be the lexical head of the whole NP. The comparison instead concerns the head-like role of *some* in that larger expression.

Figure 4 gives the D-noun analysis, with the *of*-phrase functioning as complement within Nom, as in *CGEL*'s partitive tree (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 411–412). *CGEL* represents the head-like role of *some* through Det–Head fusion. Partitives support that role while leaving the choice between fusion and ordinary headedness open.

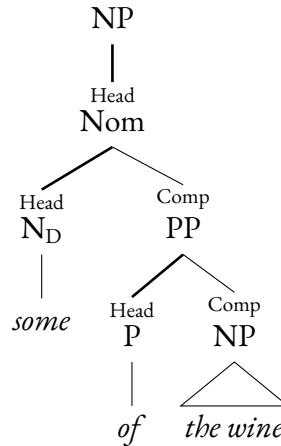


Figure 4: *Some of the wine* under the D-noun analysis. The Head relations lead from the outer NP to *some*. The common noun *wine* is inside the complement PP and doesn't head the whole expression. The inner NP is abbreviated.

The overt quantifier and domain already supply a compositional interpretation of *some of the wine*. A silent common noun would need to explain something further, such as a restriction on interpretation or modification that the overt-head account misses. The construction itself supplies no such requirement. I therefore prefer an overt-head analysis over an otherwise equivalent null-head analysis; fusion remains compatible with that preference.

4.4 MODIFICATION TESTS THE INTERNAL ANALYSIS

The pair *the lucky survivors/the lucky few* supplies a comparison involving both external determination and adjectival modification. *CGEL* explicitly permits determinatives used as internal modifiers to fuse with Head, as in *the other two* and *these few here* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 415–416). Its analysis of *the few mistakes* assigns *the* to Det and *few* to Mod (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 392). That dependent use supplies the counterpart for a Mod–Head analysis of independent *few* after an external determiner.

Figure 5 compares the resulting analyses of *the lucky few*. Both have an overt Det and a Nom modified by *lucky*. In the D-noun analysis, *few* fills Head. In the fusion analysis, its DP fills Mod–Head. The competing structure thus uses machinery already needed for adjectival fusion; it requires neither a silent noun nor conversion.

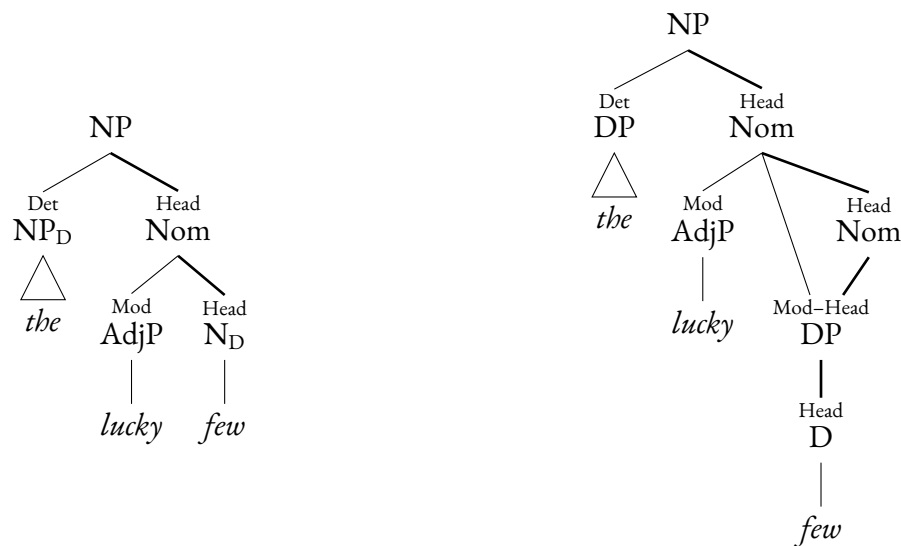


Figure 5: *The lucky few* with ordinary Head (left) and Mod-Head fusion (right). The determiner is separately realized in both. Internal structure within the article phrase and AdjP is suppressed.

Table 3 compares the Head relations across four constructions; §7.2 supplies the rules under both taxonomies.

Table 3: Head and dependent functions under matched analyses. Each independent expression is an NP; *the* fills Det wherever it appears. The ordinary-Head column applies to both taxonomies permitting ordinary determinative heads.

Expression	Separate D with fusion	Ordinary determinative Head
<i>few survivors</i>	<i>few</i> : Det; <i>survivors</i> : Head	Same functions
Independent <i>few</i>	<i>few</i> : Det-Head	<i>few</i> : Head
<i>the lucky few</i>	<i>few</i> : Mod-Head; <i>lucky</i> : Mod	<i>few</i> : Head; <i>lucky</i> : Mod
<i>the idle rich</i>	<i>rich</i> : Mod-Head; <i>idle</i> : Mod	Same fusion and modifier functions

Fusion groups *the lucky few* with *the idle rich*; ordinary headedness groups it with *the lucky survivors* and unifies bare and externally determined *few*. Both cover the example. The choice is between sharing fusion across D and adjective, and sharing ordinary Head structure across determinative constructions.

Reducing fusion's applications can simplify this description even when fusion remains available for adjectives. The advantage is the uniform treatment of *few*; its value depends on any additional conditions or lost generalizations elsewhere.¹⁰ Section 7.2 compares those costs while holding the lexical restrictions fixed.

¹⁰Compare the theory of second best in Lipsey and Lancaster (1956, pp. 11–12): under a constraint preventing an optimum, satisfying more optimality conditions needn't improve the outcome. The analogy concerns interactions among grammatical choices, not a formal optimum for the grammar.

The constructed *the remaining three* extends the modifier pattern to cardinals. It doesn't independently decide whether *three* is determinative or has a common-noun use: Reynolds (2026) argues for both uses of cardinals. Section 7.3 treats their unification as a consequence conditional on that analysis.

Relative-clause postmodification adds another nominal construction: *those who came*, *anyone who asks*, *everything that matters*, and, with books under discussion, *some that I saw*. CGEL describes relatives with demonstratives and compounds (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 414, 422–423). These clauses modify the nominal expression containing the determinative, as they do in *people who came*.

Number supplies a further distinction between determinatives and adjectives. Independent *this/these* and *that/those* retain overt singular–plural contrasts. The human-class *the rich*, by contrast, is a plural NP whose adjective lacks nominal number inflection and still takes adverb modifiers: *the very rich* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 418). The strongest morphological evidence comes from the demonstrative paradigms. The singular and plural specifications of *each* and *several* concern lexical restrictions; NP number alone doesn't distinguish the categories. Other determinatives, such as plural or non-count *some*, remain number-neutral.

Bare colour expressions and evaluative comparative subjects complicate a simple distributional boundary. CGEL's *Henrietta likes red shirts*, and *I like blue* permits colour-noun ambiguity as well as possible reduction licensed by coordination; the attested *Bluer is better* establishes a bare comparative subject without settling its phrase category.¹¹ These cases leave the wider comparison of argument distribution and head properties necessary.

The combination of argument use, nominal number properties, partitives, and modification favours ordinary determinative headedness alongside adjectival fusion.

4.5 COMPOUNDS AND MODIFIER DOMAINS

A more demanding modifier comparison is *hardly anyone present*. Payne et al. (2007, pp. 581–583) assign *hardly* to DP structure and *present* to nominal structure. The compound *anyone* takes the premodifiers of its determinative base *any*: compare *hardly any writer present*. The adjective realizes a specialized RESTRICTOR function, restricted to post-head position and non-recursive. Figure 6 contrasts this account with an ordinary-Head analysis.

¹¹The *blue*, *old*, and *small* examples on CGEL p. 417 all occur in coordinated contrasts. *Bluer is better* accompanies a results colour scale in Stanford CS329X, “Codeswitching LLMs”, slide 8 (accessed 10 September 2026). I interpret it as evaluating a degree of blueness. Subject function alone doesn't establish NP status (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 236).

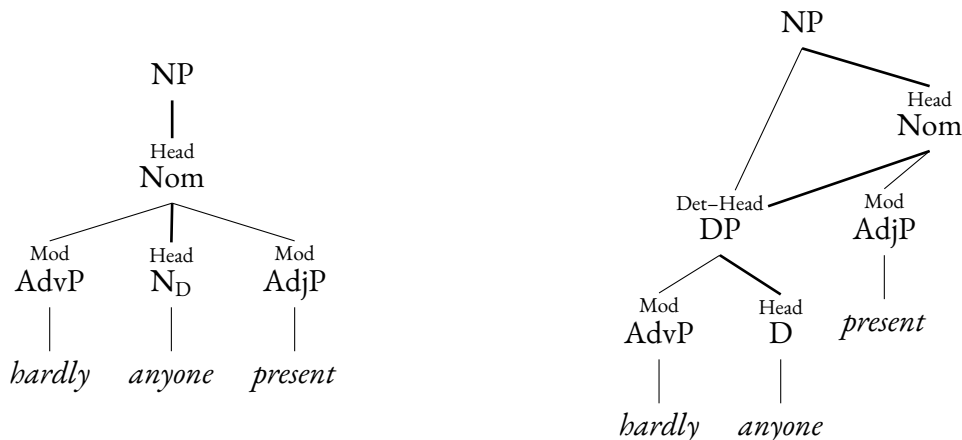


Figure 6: *Hardly anyone present* with ordinary Head (left) and fusion (right). Both post-head Mod positions realize the specialized restrictor. In the fusion tree, DP fills Det of NP and Head of Nom, following Payne et al. (2007, p. 582, (13d)). Modifier-phrase interiors are suppressed.

In the D-noun analysis, *anyone* inherits nominal projection from Noun and its premodifier permissions from its determinative base. The compound construction supplies the post-head restrictor permission, with the same position and non-recursion conditions as the fusion account. It doesn't license a corresponding pre-head adjective. The compound's ordinary argument use and exclusion of external determination are further lexical conditions; the premodifier and restrictor slots aren't unrestricted Nom dependents.

The relative clauses illustrated above are ordinary postmodifiers, distinct from the specialized restrictor. When both occur, the relative follows it: *something useful that I found*. CGEL explicitly gives compounds the common noun's range of ordinary postmodifiers while preserving this ordering condition (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 423).

This division extends to *someone* and *everybody*: the compound family licenses nominal argument use and post-head restrictors, while each base supplies its own premodifier permissions. CGELBank attests the post-head pattern in *I need something reliable and good looking*.¹²

Fusion reuses the DP–Nom boundary to separate the two modifier domains. Ordinary headedness locates both within Nom, assigning their restrictions to the determinative base and compound construction. Both accounts need the specialized restrictor condition.

4.6 PREDICATIVE USES AND THEIR RESTRICTIONS

CGEL records predicative *Its advantages are several* and *Their enemies were many*, describing the latter pattern as uncommon and formal (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 392, 395–396). This use is available to only part of the determinative inventory; *every* and the articles remain excluded.

She is a doctor ascribes a property, whereas *That is Kim* identifies a person. CGEL excludes specifying *be* clauses from its noun–adjective diagnostic because phrases from other categories occur in them too (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 536).

Nominal grammar also distinguishes predicative and argument uses. A bare-role NP such as *president* is licensed in *I'd like to be president*, but requires determination in the corresponding object use

¹²Sentence [answers-20111024111513AAQhAO_ans-0003](#) in ewt-test_iaa50.cgel.

I'd like to meet the president (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 328). Determinatives' asymmetries fit this broader variation within Noun.

4.7 WHAT THE COMBINED PATTERN SUPPORTS

The nominal constructions reinforce the semantic and morphological connections in §3. Under the D-noun analysis, bare, partitive, and externally determined uses inherit ordinary Head structure. *CGEL* distinguishes Det–Head from Mod–Head and uses the DP–Nom boundary to separate modifier domains. These are competing ways of organizing the same constructional evidence; their grammatical costs are compared in §7.2.

5 COORDINATE SUBCATEGORIES AND INHERITANCE

Should determinatives and pronouns be coordinate subcategories within Noun, or should determinatives belong inside pronoun? Reynolds (2021) compares determinative and pronoun profiles; its matrix contains no common or proper nouns. Distributional separation between the supplied groups doesn't determine their taxonomic rank or test the proposed superordinate category. The original discussion likewise leaves a nested nominal analysis open.

The accompanying audit reproduces the published DISCO decomposition, but the clustering outcome varies with initialization and feature selection.¹³

The pronoun inventory in that study follows *CGEL*'s classification, whereas Hudson's pronoun category includes the words he calls determiners. The reassignment of independent *what* and relative *which* proposed below also changes the boundary. The archived analysis therefore isn't a test of the revised membership proposed here. Comparing the hierarchies requires aligned lexical inventories and generalizations stated for each candidate superordinate category.

Nesting would group pronouns and determinatives more closely than either with common or proper nouns. Reduced descriptive content and contextual interpretation are shared by many pronouns and determinatives. The coordinate analysis can record these interpretive properties through features or cross-classification; they don't by themselves require an intermediate lexical category.

Pro-form gender links pronouns and determinatives (§3.1). The personhood-based system also includes non-nominal expressions (Reynolds, 2025); it doesn't by itself decide between coordinate and nested noun subcategories.

Restrictions on determination and attributive modification provide syntactic candidates, but they also occur outside the proposed grouping. In their primary use, proper names don't select freely from the determiner system, and their adjectival embellishments are restricted (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 517, 519–520). These properties distinguish more than pronouns and determinatives from common nouns.

Determination also differs within the proposed intermediate category. Determinatives permit external determination in a range of independent quantificational constructions: *the few*, *the many*, *the two*, *these three*. The permissions vary by item and often require further modification; *CGEL* gives *these few here* and *the many who did* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 415–416). Pronouns admit external determination only marginally, and internal premodification is restricted, as in *poor*

¹³The accompanying [Replication audit of the English determinative–pronoun feature matrix](#) documents the discrepancy between the reported 232 features and the public 155-feature file, an extra feature dropped by the published clustering code, and the sensitivity results. The archived public file is retained unchanged.

old me (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 429–430). These restrictions thus cross-cut the proposed grouping and vary within it.

I place determinative alongside pronoun because their shared nominal properties coexist with different centres of grammatical organization. Pronouns centre on person, case, reflexivity, and contextual reference; determinatives centre on quantification, determination, and their associated modifier patterns. The wider modifier permissions of determinatives would in particular prevent the restrictions on personal pronouns from being inherited by the whole nested grouping. Coordination preserves the distinctions without adding an intermediate pronoun category whose common rules remain to be established.

6 RESTRICTED MEMBERS AND DISPUTED BOUNDARIES

The broader grouping must accommodate members that lack its most conspicuous properties. Articles test whether ordinary independent use is necessary; *which* and *what* test the pronoun boundary; *no/none* and *enough* test form selection and functions outside NP structure.

6.1 ARTICLES AND THE LIMITS OF INDEPENDENT USE

Why classify the articles *the* and *a* as nouns if they can't stand independently? *Every* is restricted too, while *no* has the distinct independent form *none* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 371–372, 410–411).¹⁴

CGEL's treatment of *my* supplies a precedent for restricted membership within Noun (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 470–471). The pronoun's paradigm supports its membership despite its lack of *mine*'s independent distribution. For articles, the corresponding positive evidence is integration into determinative; their nounhood depends on the category-level argument.

The articles participate in the determinative system of definiteness, quantity, and count restrictions. In *the/a/this/every book*, they occupy the same Det position and contribute to the interpretation of the NP. *The* permits singular, plural, and non-count targets; *a* selects a singular count target and contributes individuation. Their connections extend beyond shared position, although neither has the full determinative profile (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 368–373).

A also enters the complex determinatives *a few*, *a little*, and *many a*. In the last, *many* contributes a large number and *a* an individuating, distributive effect. *CGEL* treats *many a* as syntactically fixed: it doesn't establish that ordinary *a* freely accepts modifiers (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 392–394). It does connect the article with quantificational constructions beyond *a book*.

Every connects with independent *each* through universal quantification and singular count selection. It also permits *almost/nearly* and occurs after genitives in *her every move*. Spinillo (2004, pp. 156–158) recognizes these differences from *the* and *a*, as well as the articles' greater phonological dependence. Her restricted grouping is thus a substantive alternative, not merely an omission of inconvenient properties.

The issue is how much independent support its shared restrictions provide. Absence of bare, predicative, and partitive uses all limits occurrence without a following nominal; they aren't three independent reasons for a primary category. Little descriptive content extends well beyond the trio. Meanwhile, *a*'s quantificational constructions and *every*'s modifier permissions cross the proposed

¹⁴In *the bigger the better*, *CGEL* analyses *the* as a modifier within a comparative phrase (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 1131–1132, 1135–1136). This dependent use outside Det leaves the restriction on ordinary argument use intact.

article boundary. I retain the restricted members within determinative because these connections preserve a broader system without granting unrestricted use to any member.

The argument for retaining the articles is synchronic. Grammaticalization supplies background: C. Lyons (1999, pp. 331–336) discusses the development of definite articles from demonstratives and of articles expressing cardinality from numerals. These histories can explain changes in content and use, but don't establish the synchronic classification.

The D-noun analysis retains the shared determining profile and records the absence of independent use in lexical permissions. The articles' nounhood depends on their membership in that broader system. They don't individually exhibit the full evidence that supports the parent category.

6.2 THE PRONOUN BOUNDARY: ⟨who⟩, ⟨which⟩, AND ⟨what⟩

Who has positive morphological grounds for pronoun status: its paradigm includes nominative *who*, accusative *whom*, and genitive *whose* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 904–905). *What* lacks a comparable case paradigm. That absence alone wouldn't exclude it from pronoun, but independent use and a non-personal interpretation don't establish pronounhood either. Both properties occur among determinatives, including the *-thing* compounds.

CGEL assigns interrogative *what* to two categories. Before an overt nominal it's determinative, as in *what book* or *what person*; independently it's a non-personal pronoun, as in *What arrived?* Relative *what/whatever* receives a corresponding split. The stated contrast concerns gender: the independent forms are non-personal, while the determinatives permit personal and non-personal heads (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 398).

I treat these occurrences as determinatives throughout. With an overt nominal, that nominal supplies the restriction; without one, the construction requires a non-personal interpretation. This states the contrast as a use condition instead of assigning a second lexical category on its basis. The determinative analysis preserves *what*'s connection across the constructions while distinguishing its gender restrictions from those of *which*.

Interrogative *which* is already determinative in *CGEL* both before a nominal and independently: compare *Which candidate arrived?* and *Which arrived?* With candidates under discussion, the latter can be personal. It also permits *which of the candidates*, whereas **what of the candidates* doesn't have the corresponding selective reading (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 397–398). Determinative membership therefore doesn't predict identical gender or partitive permissions.

Relative *which* poses the same boundary question as *what*. *CGEL* treats it as determinative in *at which stage*, but as a non-personal pronoun in *the post office, which is nearby* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 399). I retain determinative here too, with the non-personal restriction attached to this relative construction. This changes lexical classification, leaving relative-clause syntax, including fused relatives, to be analysed separately. Either classification places these words within the proposed superordinate Noun.

Exclamative *what* in *What a nice day!* remains a separate case. Following *CGEL*, I retain its adjective analysis here (§3.1). A common spelling doesn't require one lexeme across all constructions. Nor does being a PRO-FORM determine lexical category: gender-sensitive interpretation must be distinguished from the grammatical evidence for pronoun membership (Reynolds, 2025).

6.3 FORM SELECTION AND DEGREE MODIFICATION

No/none illustrates a restriction on forms within a paradigm. *CGEL* treats them as inflectional forms of one determinative: dependent *no students* contrasts with independent *none*, while both permit *almost* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 389–390). The D-noun analysis preserves this relation. Ordinary Head structure licenses *none of the students*; it doesn't license **no of the students*. Form selection remains necessary, just as with *my/mine*.

Enough tests both position and external function. It precedes a nominal in *enough money* and can follow one in *money enough*; post-head *enough* can't itself be premodified, as shown by **money almost enough* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 396–397, 445). Only the permitted construction licenses each position.

Enough also modifies adjectives, adverbs, verbs, and some PPs: *good enough*, *quickly enough*, *I hadn't prepared enough*, and *enough in control* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 396–397). The degree determinatives *much* and *little*, and *no/none*, likewise have uses outside NP structure (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 390, 395–397). These permissions must survive reclassification. Noun membership doesn't confine every projection to argument or determiner function.

NPs already modify adjectives in *three years old*, *a great deal smaller*, and *plenty big enough* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 549–550). These include the quantificational common nouns compared in §3.1. Degree modification therefore supplies another connection with existing nouns, but also another restriction: *CGEL* contrasts predicative *a great deal better* with its exclusion before a noun in **some a great deal better proposals*, where *much better* is permitted (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 551–552).

The D-noun analysis must preserve that difference between two kinds of NP modifier. It expands NP's range of degree-modifier uses while restricting their positions by head and construction. The resulting cost is that the existing ban on pre-head NP modifiers within attributive AdjPs becomes a narrower condition. Nominal projection alone doesn't license *enough*'s full distribution.

7 STRUCTURAL CONSEQUENCES AND GRAMMATICAL ECONOMY

7.1 A SHARED PHRASE TYPE IN DETERMINER FUNCTION

In *some apples* and *Kim's apples*, the determining phrases share the NP category under both ordinary-Head accounts: D-noun and separate D. *CGEL* instead distinguishes DP from genitive NP. It also admits a restricted range of plain-case NPs and PPs as determiners, as in *what size hat* and *over thirty ties* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, Ch. 5, §4). The phrase types are:

CGEL: Det : {DP, NP, PP}

Both ordinary-Head accounts: Det : {NP, PP}

This shares a phrase type without shortening the selectional disjunction: determinative-headed, genitive, and other licensed NPs still require separate identification. *CGEL* already states definiteness and the single-Det restriction functionally, so reclassification doesn't derive them. The following fragment compares projection once those restrictions are held fixed.

7.2 A MATCHED DESCRIPTIVE FRAGMENT

A grammatical FRAGMENT is a set of rules for a specified range of constructions. Here it covers determination, ordinary subject and object uses, partitives, and the modifier and compound comparisons in §4. It compares the D-noun analysis with two separate-D alternatives: ordinary headedness and

fusion. All receive the same lexical restrictions and constructed judgments. Predication, the disputed wh forms, and modification outside NP structure fall outside this small fragment; their implications enter the broader comparison in §7.3.

Table 4 records USE PERMISSIONS: whether a form, on a given reading, can head a phrase in determiner, subject, or object function. ARGUMENT USE covers the subject and object NPs in examples such as *Some left* and *I saw some*. Quotation, metalinguistic naming, and subordinate-clause uses of dependent genitives fall outside the fragment. Noun membership doesn't itself grant a use permission.

Table 4: Shared permissions in the fragment. For *some*, the target column concerns its unstressed use before a noun. The inventory is deliberately limited to the displayed constructions.

Form	Det use	Argument use	Target in the Det construction
<i>the</i>	yes	no	Singular or plural; count or non-count
<i>a, every</i>	yes	no	Singular count nominal
<i>some</i>	yes	yes	Plural count or non-count nominal
<i>few</i>	yes	yes	Plural count nominal
<i>my</i>	yes	no	No number/count restriction in this fragment
<i>she</i>	no	yes	None

Further constructional restrictions apply: *she* is a subject form, whereas the corresponding ordinary object form is *her*. The target restrictions concern the common-noun nominal being determined: *a* requires a singular count target such as *book* in *a book*.

Table 5 locates the three accounts. Comparing the ordinary-Head accounts holds projection fixed while varying taxonomy. Comparing the separate-D accounts holds taxonomy fixed while varying headedness.

Table 5: Three accounts retaining the permissions in Table 4, the modifier restrictions, and the compound conditions.

Account	Primary taxonomy	Simple independent determinative
D-noun analysis	D inside Noun	N–Nom–NP projection with Head function
Separate D, ordinary Head	D outside Noun	D–Nom–NP through cross-category projection
CGEL: separate D, fusion	D outside Noun	NP distribution through Det–Head

The D-noun analysis applies nominal projection to determinatives through their membership in Noun. A separate condition checks use permissions. In the schemata below, *h* identifies the lexical head throughout its projection; parentheses mark optional dependents. The subscripts on Mod

distinguish pre-head and post-head positions of the same modifier function. The head's entry and construction restrict every dependent.

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Nom}_h &\rightarrow (\text{Mod}_{\text{pre}}) \quad \text{Head} : \text{N}_h \quad (\text{Comp}) \quad (\text{Mod}_{\text{post}}) \\ \text{NP}_h &\rightarrow (\text{Det}) \quad \text{Head} : \text{Nom}_h \\ \text{licensed}(\text{NP}_h, f, c) &\iff f \in U_h \wedge C_h(f, c) \end{aligned}$$

Here U_h is the head's set of use permissions, f is the NP's function, and C_h checks the lexical and constructional conditions in context c . For Det use, these include compatibility with the target nominal; for an argument headed by a singular count common noun, they include required determination. Optionality in the second rule doesn't override those conditions.

These checks accommodate the reciprocal selection discussed by Hudson (§2.2). The determining phrase checks the target nominal's count and number properties; the outer noun's projection checks whether determination is required and supplied. Both conditions have to hold even though the tree assigns only one Head to each phrase.

In *some apples*, *some* heads an NP whose Det permission and plural-count target requirement are satisfied. *Apples* heads the outer Nom, which heads the NP. In *Some left*, *some* heads an NP whose argument permission is satisfied. *Every apple* passes the Det and singular-count checks; ordinary independent **Every arrived* fails the argument-permission check. *The apple* and **The arrived* differ in the same way.

Each NP's use permissions follow its own head. In *the apple*, the article's Det permission licenses the dependent NP headed by *the*. The outer NP takes its argument permission from *apple*, whose requirement for determination is satisfied by the article.

A singular count common noun such as *book* faces a different restriction from an article. In *a book*, its requirement for determination is satisfied; bare **Book arrived* leaves that requirement unsatisfied. *Books arrived* has no such requirement. Requiring determination for a common noun doesn't itself block an article-headed NP from argument use. An article's exclusion from argument use must still be stated separately.

Some and *few* permit a partitive *of*-phrase within their nominal projection. *Almost* can modify *every* in *almost every teacher*; that permission doesn't license *experienced* as a modifier of *every*. The construction *the lucky few* permits the external determiner and adjectival modifier shown in Figure 5.

Keeping ordinary headedness while retaining primary D gives the strongest separate-D alternative. It retains the NP and use-permission rules, but replaces the lexical-head restriction in Nom with:

$$\text{Nom}_h \rightarrow (\text{Mod}_{\text{pre}}) \quad \text{Head} : \{\text{N}_h, \text{D}_h\} \quad (\text{Comp}) \quad (\text{Mod}_{\text{post}})$$

This projection applies to dependent as well as independent determinatives, eliminating DP from the fragment while retaining primary D. Determiner selection still identifies D-headed NPs and suitable genitives. In *the lucky few*, *few* is D in ordinary Head function. In *hardly anyone present*, the determinative base and compound construction supply the same modifier restrictions as the D-noun account. Adjectival Mod-Head fusion remains available in both.

The separate-D fusion account relates independent determinatives to their dependent counterparts. In addition to nominal projection for nouns, it uses DP projection and permits a DP to realize a fused function in nominal structure. The partitive complement and compound restrictor belong

to Nom, following the trees in *CGEL* and Payne et al. (2007, p. 582):

$$\begin{aligned} DP_h &\rightarrow (\text{Mod}_{\text{pre}}) \quad \text{Head} : D_h \quad (\text{Comp}) \\ \text{Nom}_h &\rightarrow (\text{Mod}_{\text{pre}}) \quad F : DP_h \quad (\text{Comp}) \quad (\text{Mod}_{\text{post}}) \\ F &\in \{\text{Det-Head}, \text{Mod-Head}\} \end{aligned}$$

The ordinary NP rule embeds this Nom. Det-Head jointly realizes Det of NP and Head of Nom, excluding a second Det; Mod-Head fills an internal modifier's function and Head of Nom, allowing external determination. Lexical and constructional conditions select the fused function and permitted dependents. These schemata cover independent *few*, *few of them*, *the lucky few*, and *hardly anyone present*.

The ordinary-Head accounts share nominal projection and Head relations. Once a member's use is licensed, its nominal structure follows from the shared rules; lexical and constructional conditions still determine the available functions and dependents. Dependent determinatives acquire a Nom layer in both. One account supplies these common structural expectations through inheritance from Noun, the other through a rule admitting both N and D.

The disjunction {N, D} groups the same heads for nominal projection. The D-noun analysis expresses this grouping in its lexical hierarchy, giving a point of HARMONY between taxonomy and phrase structure. Shared projection supports considering the grouping; its taxonomic rank depends on the broader profile comparison.

A grammar with Hudson's nested classification can use the same permissions and projection rules. Holding those rules fixed, placing the broader pronoun category on determinative's inheritance path from Noun leaves the fragment's judgments unchanged.

7.3 EXISTING RESTRICTIONS, ADDITIONAL COSTS, AND CONSEQUENCES

I compare the shared structural core, the number of primary categories, the treatment of internal differences, the placement of related forms and uses, and the restrictions each account needs. I hold the inventory, constructions, and readings fixed. Shared rules receive equal credit whether they use inheritance or cross-category licensing.

Common nouns, proper nouns, and pronouns already differ in determination and permitted modifiers (Table 2). Preserving those conditions adds no cost to the D-noun analysis. Separate D likewise restricts adverbial modification and independent use within its own category; moving those restrictions inside Noun doesn't create them.

The premodifier contrast in §3.3 adds a cost. A restriction normally stated for primary Noun now applies to specified noun subcategories, while determinatives retain their adverbial premodifiers. The attributive *almost textbook* exception qualifies the original generalization. The degree-modifier contrast in §6.3 adds a parallel cost: determinative-headed NPs are admitted in positions that exclude other NP modifiers. Compound constructions also retain the distinction between inherited premodifier permissions and post-head restrictors (§4.5).

On shared structure, the ordinary-Head accounts tie. D-noun reduces the number of primary categories by one, retaining determinative as a subcategory and preserving its internal distinctions.

Reynolds (2026) distinguishes determinative uses such as *ten men*, proper-noun uses such as *Room 101*, and common-noun uses such as *tens of pens*. Under the D-noun analysis, all fall within

primary Noun, retaining their subcategory and constructional differences. Ordinals remain adjectives, and complex numeral phrases remain distinct from single lexemes.

Payne et al. (2013, pp. 797–798) distinguish three lexemes spelled *one*: determinative, anaphoric common noun, and generic pronoun. These remain distinct under the D-noun analysis, but all belong within primary Noun.

Complex cardinals also separate category from function. In *two hundred books*, the whole *two hundred* fills Det; internally, *two* modifies the magnitude head *hundred* (Reynolds, 2026, §4). In *these two hundred books*, *these* fills Det and *two hundred* is an internal modifier. One Det function doesn't entail a limit of one determinative lexeme per NP.

Cardinal uses and the lexemes spelled *one* remain within one primary category. Reassigning *what* and relative *which* likewise relocates a boundary inside Noun. These connected consequences of the hierarchy show what its alignment with nominal projection buys once the broader profile supports the grouping.

I favour the broader Noun category because it places the recurring nominal structure at the shared level and preserves the determinative distinctions where their restrictions apply. The alternative retains a primary boundary and crosses it in the projection rule. Both are coherent grammars. The choice turns on whether the shared profile warrants that parent category, with the modifier restrictions counted against it; reducing the number of primary categories alone wouldn't suffice.

If determinative-headed and genitive expressions require different projection rules after their independently motivated restrictions are held fixed, the shared-projection proposal in §7.1 loses its advantage. That would favour separate phrase types. Retaining a separate primary D requires the further case that the category boundary captures the recurring differences better than a determinative subcategory within Noun.

8 CONCLUSION

English determinatives belong within Noun as a coordinate subcategory alongside common nouns, proper nouns, and pronouns. The combined case draws on argument and determiner functions, referential contrasts, inflection, and nominal dependents. Quantificational common nouns make the connection especially clear: their selected partitives and restricted dependents already occupy part of the grammatical territory associated with determinatives.

The resulting category retains internal differences. Articles lack ordinary independent uses; the *no/none* paradigm requires form selection; degree modifiers require construction-specific permissions. I retain *who* as a pronoun and analyse interrogative and relative *what* as determinative, with explicit interpretive restrictions. These distinctions constrain the proposed subcategories within their shared parent.

Determinatives then inherit nominal projection and ordinary Head relations across bare, partitive, and externally determined uses. A separate-D grammar can reproduce that structure through cross-category licensing. I prefer the hierarchy that makes the recurring nominal grouping explicit, accepting the narrower modifier generalizations it requires. It aligns lexical classification with the broader grammatical profile while preserving determinatives' distinctive place within Noun.

DATA AND ANALYSIS MATERIALS

The accompanying supplements are *Replication audit of the English determinative-pronoun feature matrix* and *CGELBank concordance and extraction notes*. The analysis/ directory preserves their input files, provenance records, scripts, numerical outputs, and sentence concordance. Its README identifies the files and reproduction procedures.

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